

Chicago Tribune



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FRIDAY, DECEMBER 12, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Health care measures rejected by US Senate

Extending subsidies for ACA, creating savings accounts fail

By Mary Clare Jalonick
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The Senate on Thursday rejected legislation to extend Affordable Care Act tax credits, essentially guaranteeing that millions of Americans will see a steep rise in costs at the beginning of the year.

Senators rejected a Democratic bill to extend the subsidies for three years and a Republican alternative that would have created new health savings accounts — an unceremonious end to a monthslong effort by Democrats to prevent the COVID-19-era subsidies from expiring on Jan. 1.

Ahead of the votes, Senate Democratic leader Chuck Schumer of New York warned Republicans that if they did not vote to extend the tax credits, “there won’t be another chance to act,” before premiums rise for many people who buy insurance off the ACA marketplaces, also called Obamacare.

“Let’s avert a disaster,” Schumer said. “The American people are watching.”

Republicans have argued that Affordable Care Act plans are too expensive and need to be overhauled. The health savings accounts in the GOP bill would have given money directly to consumers instead of to insurance companies, an idea that has been echoed by President Donald Trump.

Senate Majority Leader John Thune, R-S.D., said ahead of the vote that a simple extension of the subsidies is “an attempt to disguise the real impact of Obamacare’s spiraling health care costs.”

But Democrats immediately rejected the GOP plan, saying the accounts wouldn’t be enough to cover costs for most consumers.

The dueling Senate votes are the latest political messaging exercise in a Congress that has operated

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A protester celebrates outside the Indiana Senate Chamber after a bill to redistrict the state’s congressional map was defeated Thursday at the Capitol in Indianapolis. **MICHAEL CONROY/AP**

Illinois Dems applaud as Indiana rebuffs remap

Heavily Republican Senate rejects plan aimed at giving state 2 more GOP US House seats

By Rick Pearson
and Alexandra Kukulka
Chicago Tribune

The heavily Republican-led Indiana Senate on Thursday rejected a mid-decade redistricting plan aimed at giving the state two additional GOP U.S. House members in a sharp rebuke to President Donald Trump’s pressure to try to help maintain a congressional majority in next year’s midterm elections.

Needing 25 votes for passage, only 19 Indiana state senators backed the plan, which the Indiana House had already approved, as 31 senators rejected

it. The remap was designed to extend Indiana’s 7-2 GOP U.S. House delegation to 9-0 Republican. The state Senate chamber comprises 40 Republicans and 10 Democrats, meaning a majority of its GOP caucus sided against the rare mid-decade redistricting push.

Illinois played a role in the debate. Supporters of the effort cited Democratic-led states, such as Illinois, to argue that Indiana needed to act because heavily partisan congressional boundaries have denied the GOP proper representation in Washington, D.C. Illinois’ current map has resulted in a 14-3 Democratic

House majority in its congressional delegation.

Led by Gov. JB Pritzker, Illinois Democrats had been awaiting the outcome of the Indiana vote, warning that Illinois was ready to respond by redrawing its own boundaries to try to squeeze out at least one additional Democratic U.S. House district if Indiana Republicans had approved the new map. For now, it appears Illinois will stand down in that effort.

“Our neighbors in Indiana have stood up to Trump’s threats and political pressure, instead choosing to do what’s right for their constituents and our democracy,”

Pritzker said in a statement on X. “Illinois will remain vigilant against his map rigging — our efforts to respond and stop his campaign are being heard.”

Democratic Illinois House Speaker Emanuel “Chris” Welch described Indiana Republicans who voted against the remap as “courageous” and said they “rightly stood up to Donald Trump’s gerrymandering schemes.”

“To protect and preserve our Republic, we need more Republicans across the country to stand up and fight back against Trump

Turn to Indiana, Page 7



Yolanda Rivera, center, the mother of Krystal Rivera, is comforted by Krystal Rivera’s sister Jackie Rivera and stepfather, Rico Thompson, during a news conference on Thursday. **EILEENT. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Family of dead officer Rivera files suit against CPD, partner

She was shot during operation on South Side in rare incident

By Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

In late May, Chicago police Officer Krystal Rivera ended an off-and-on romantic relationship with her partner, fellow Officer Carlos Baker, according to her family and attorneys.

Just days later, Baker shot and

killed her while the two tactical officers tried to arrest a weapons suspect on the South Side. Rivera, 36, was the first CPD officer to die in a friendly fire incident in nearly 40 years.

Rivera’s family on Thursday filed a nine-count lawsuit against Baker, the city and Chicago Police Department, alleging willful and wanton conduct, negligence and intentional infliction of emotional distress.

“Every day is painful as we continue to grieve the loss of

my daughter, Krystal,” Rivera’s mother, Yolanda Rivera, said at a news conference Thursday. “Her child, her sisters, our family, (and) an entire community miss her deeply.

“From this moment forward, my purpose is simple: that those responsible for her death must be held accountable.”

Attorneys for Rivera’s family said Baker was profoundly unfit to be a police officer, as demon-

Turn to Lawsuit, Page 5

Jones makes deal with feds on prosecution

State senator will have no conviction if he admits to certain conduct, pays fine

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A month before his scheduled retrial on bribery charges, state Sen. Emil Jones III has agreed to enter into a deferred prosecution deal that will leave him with no conviction as long as he admits to certain illegal conduct and pays a fine.

The agreement with the U.S. attorney’s office was announced at a hearing Thursday before U.S. District Judge Andrea Wood and scuttles a trial that had been set for Jan. 12.

Under the terms of the deal, Jones agreed to pay a fine of \$6,800, stay out of legal trouble, and make admissions about his meetings with FBI mole Omar Maani and false statements he later made to the FBI about how much Maani paid Jones’ intern.

If Jones lives up to his end of the bargain, the charges against him



Illinois state Sen. Emil Jones III makes a thumbs-up gesture as he leaves the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse in Chicago on April 23 after another day of deliberation in his federal bribery trial. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

will be dropped in December 2026.

Dressed in a brown suit, Jones stood at the lectern in court Thursday and told the judge he was satisfied with the work of his attorneys. When the judge asked if he wished to enter into the agreement, he answered, “Absolutely” in a deep

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INSIDE

Report: Change business property tax breaks

Cook County Board President Toni Preckwinkle is looking to revamp the program that shifts tax levies to others. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

SOME DELICIOUS FUN: A handy viewer’s guide to bowl season, from best Big Ten-SEC matchup to Snoop Dogg to extra mayo. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY’S
WEATHER



High 31

Low 5

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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